

Vinoba Bhave (1895–1982) was a widely known and respected Gandhian reformer who began the Bhoodan movement in the 1950s. It was aimed at encouraging large landowners to redress historical wrongs by voluntarily giving up some of their land to the poor.

Poverty, illiteracy, and discrimination on the basis of gender, religion and caste are some of the most enduring challenges that India has faced in its long history.

For both the nationalist leaders and the Indian government after Independence, the need to confront historical discrimination and to find solutions to the social inequality it created shaped both the framing of the Indian constitution and the priorities of the Indian government in the first few decades after 1947.

However, alongside the government's efforts, there have always been individuals who have striven to create social change, often by dedicating their lives to specific causes.